#7 Return the computed values.

The implementation of the utility method is straightforward, assuming we have a way to extract the longest common prefix of two strings: this can be done by comparing the characters at the same indices in the two strings, one by one, until we find a mismatch.

We assume that this method is given, and it also returns the suffixes of the two strings, meaning two strings made of the remaining characters in each of the input strings, once stripped of their common prefix.

Figure 6.16 shows an example of the search method on the radix tree resulting from compressing the trie in figure 6.3.

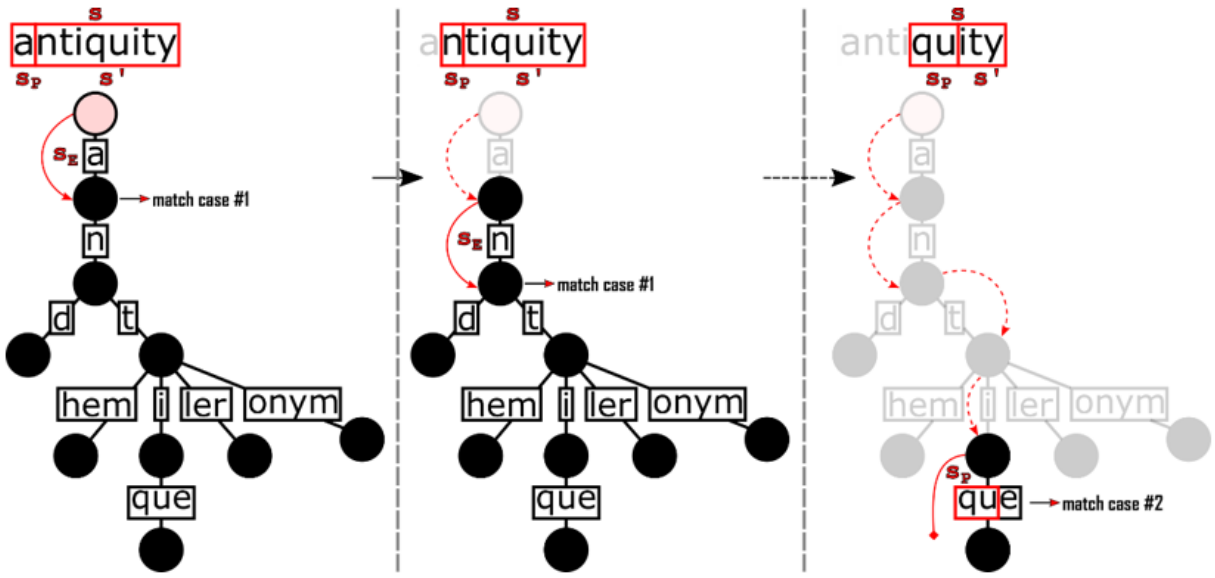


Figure 6.16 Unsuccessful search for the string “`antiquity`” in the radix tree corresponding to the trie in figure 6.3. The first two diagrams show the initial steps in the search, then we fast forward to the final step.